



scoring more than 500 runs in this span at a strike rate of 162. Despite declining consistency and impact in T20 leagues, Glenn Maxwell and Marcus Stoinis continue to contribute for Australia and will provide balance with their all-round skill sets.

Test captain Pat Cummins is included despite not featuring in any T20I since the last World Cup. His inclusion pushed Sean Abbott, who had the third-most wickets for the team since 2024, out of the squad. Cummins will play a supporting role to Josh Hazlewood and Nathan Ellis. Adam Zampa, Australia's highest wicket-taker in T20Is, will lead the spin attack, with Matthew Kuhnemann providing a defensive alternative. Despite playing just four T20Is so far, Kuhnemann impressed with his accuracy and ability to control the run flow during the series against India. Maxwell, Matthew Short and Cooper Connolly are the

part-time spin options at Marsh's disposal.

Sri Lanka announced a larger provisional squad for the tournament and is yet to prune it down to 15 players. The island nation has had extensive preparation in subcontinent conditions, with 24 of its last 30 matches played in the region. Thirteen of those were at home, where it will contest all its group matches. Much like Australia, Sri Lanka has a settled top order. Pathum Nissanka is one of only three batters from full-member sides to record more than 1,000 T20I runs since the previous World Cup. Kusal

Standout talent: Well attuned to subcontinent conditions, Nissanka is one of the players to watch. AP

Perera, an ever-present in the team, found himself out of the playing eleven in the home series against Pakistan after a run of poor scores since the 2025 Asia Cup.

Sri Lanka's problems surface at the death, with Shanaka acting as the lone batter capable of consistent late-innings power. Janith Liyanage has impressed in his opportunities, but his middle-order strike rate of 122.85 needs an uptick. The team will

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